19 Now, using the cutting tool of your choice, turn the body of the pen down to whatever shape you wish. Ebonite is very abrasive and it blunts cutting tools quickly, so start with your tools honed to razor sharpness and re-hone every few minutes as soon as the edge becomes dull. Remove the tailstock support should you need to, to make the finer (and lighter) cuts needed to shape the tip

20 Once shaped, sand the component in preparation for final finishing. I would not recommend polishing until you have done a final check for a good fit of the two parts of the pen

21 The pen is fitted with the clip insert, clip and finial screw fitting from the flat top kit. Press the insert into place once the cap is shaped and finish and then screw the clip and finial into place

22 Carry out the shaping between centres. I used a stepped centre in the collet chuck of the lathe, but a normal 60° dead centre would be fine. Size your work using callipers, occasionally checking against the other components to ensure accuracy

23 Apply your chosen finish to complete the cap. I used CA for a high gloss, but there are many alternatives available. Assemble the clip components to finish this part of the job

24 Do one final check for fit, then return the Ebonite section to the lathe and polish with Micro-Mesh and/or suitable polishing compounds

25 Your final pen should look something like this. The finished pen is unique and will reflect your own design choices. You could make it a little thinner if you choose, but do not over do this or you will make the unsupported wooden part of the cap too thin and weak. I may revisit mine and turn a brass centre band to add a highlight between the upper and lower parts ●

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